

Agency Market Research

This guide shows you how to research federal agencies before you bid, so you know who buys what you sell.

What it is. This is your intel brief before a mission. It's about digging into a federal agency to understand their buying patterns. You're figuring out who buys what you sell, which contract vehicles they use, who the current contractor is, and most importantly, who the real decision-makers are. The goal is to walk into any conversation already knowing the buyer's needs and history.

When to use it. Use this before you spend serious bid and proposal money. If you're targeting a new agency, or considering a specific opportunity over, say, \$150,000, this research is essential. It helps you decide if an agency is a good fit for your firm and if a specific bid is worth pursuing.

How to use it.

- Open the "Federal Market Research Playbook" file in this folder. It walks you through each step.
- Start with [SAM.gov](https://sam.gov) and USAspending. Look for agencies that have bought your type of services or products in the past. Identify their spending trends.
- Then, use [FPDS.gov](https://fpds.gov) and agency forecast sites. Pinpoint the contract vehicles they prefer and who the current incumbent contractors are for similar work.
- Dig deeper. Use agency organizational charts and public directories to find specific program offices and key decision makers. Understand their pain points.

Watch out for. Don't just collect data. Focus on actionable intelligence for specific agencies or opportunities. It's easy to get lost in general data, but your goal is to understand *one* buyer well, not *all* buyers vaguely.

Open it in your kit: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/market-research> Next step: <https://app.capturepilot.com/kit/sources-sought> (Sources Sought & RFI)